



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2024-25
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I [SETA]

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

*Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.
You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.
This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.
The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.*

*Attempt all five questions.
The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].
This paper consists of five printed pages.*

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- (i) Write an original story that begins with the words: “Ajay was the funniest boy who...”
- (ii) Your flight suddenly faced turbulence and had to make an emergency landing on a deserted island. You along with other passengers were stranded on that island and were later rescued. Narrate your experience and the series of events that led to your rescue.
- (iii) Describe your school. Give details of the things you see, hear and experience when you walk around different areas of your school at different times of the day. What do you especially like about your school?
- (iv) ‘AI powered tools are a blessing in our lives.’ Give your views either for or against the statement.
- (v) Study the picture given below. Write a story, a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- (i) Your friend, a passionate artist, faced challenges and did not perform well in an Inter-School Art competition. Write a letter to that friend encouraging him/her to stay hopeful and try again with renewed energy. Suggest tips or ways that can help him/her perform better in future competitions. Also invite him/her to visit your home the next week to spend some quality time together.
- (ii) Write a letter to the Superintendent of Police expressing your concern about people riding on their bicycles while speaking on their mobile phones. State ways to restrict the cyclists from using their phones while cycling, the dangers associated with it and highlight the necessity of creating a cycling lane on busy highways.

Question 3

- (i) Your school is organising an Inter-School Football Tournament. Draft a notice for your school notice board inviting the students of classes IX and X to take part in this event. [5]
- (ii) You are the Sports Captain of your school. Write an e-mail to the Principal of a neighbouring school requesting him/her to send a team to participate in the Inter-School Football Tournament. Give details of the event. [5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

[20]

Billy Weaver had travelled down from London, and by the time he arrived, it was nine o'clock in the night, and the moon was coming up.

"Excuse me," he asked a porter. "But is there a cheap hotel nearby?"

"Try The Bell Hotel," the porter answered, pointing down the road.

Billy thanked him, picked up his suitcase, and set out to walk the distance to The Bell Hotel. He had never been to Richmond before. But the man at the office had told him it was a splendid city.

Billy was seventeen years old. He was wearing a new navy-blue overcoat, a new brown hat, and a new brown suit, and he was feeling fine. He walked briskly down the street. He was trying to do everything briskly these days. The big shots up at the Head Office were fantastically brisk all the time. They were amazing. The road was lonely and dark with a few scattered houses.

Suddenly, in a downstairs window, Billy saw a printed notice propped up against the window glass. It said Bed and Breakfast.

He moved a bit closer and peered through the window into the room, and the first thing he saw was a bright fire burning in the hearth. On the carpet in front of the fire, a little dog was curled up asleep with its nose tucked into its belly. The room in half-darkness was filled with pleasant furniture. There was a piano and a big sofa and several plump armchairs; and in one corner, he spotted a large parrot in a cage. Animals were usually a good sign in a place like this, Billy told himself, and it looked to him as though it would be a pretty decent house to stay in.

Then a queer thing happened to him. He was in the act of stepping back and going away from the window when he felt a strange urge to ring the bell!

He pressed the bell. He heard it ringing, and then at once, the door swung open and a woman was standing there. She gave him a warm, welcoming smile.

"Please come in," she said pleasantly. Billy found himself automatically moving forward into the house.

"I saw the notice in the window," he said, holding himself back.

"Yes, I know."

"I was wondering about a room."

"It's all ready for you, my dear," she said. She had a round pink face, very gentle blue eyes.

"How much do you charge?"

"Five dollars a night, including breakfast."

It was fantastically cheap. He could easily afford it.

(i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage): [2]

1. *splendid*

(a) interesting

(b) magnificent

(c) clean

(d) comfortable

2. *queer*

(a) strange

(b) frightening

(c) embarrassing

(d) funny

(ii) Which word in the passage means the opposite of the word 'slowly'? [1]

(a) fantastically

(b) automatically

(c) briskly

(d) pleasantly

(iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

(a) How did the porter assist Billy? [2]

(b) Why did Billy want to do everything briskly? What did he see propped up against the window? [2]

(c) How old was Billy? How was he dressed? [2]

(d) How much did the room cost? Give one character trait of the woman whom Billy met. [2]

(e) Why do you think Billy thought that the animals were a good sign in a place like that? [1]

(iv) In not more than 50 words describe what Billy saw when he looked through the window of the room. [8]

Question 5

(i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in the correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. Example (0) felt [4]

Now, our journey (0) _____ (feel) even more dangerous. The professor (1) _____ (is) frightened, but nothing could stop him from (2) _____ (go) to the centre of the earth. Hans continued to sail the boat, but we did not see land. We (3) _____ (have travel) for hours, but we did not (4) _____ (hear) or see anything. Then, there was a sound like fast running water. We couldn't see it, but we could hear it. It got louder. Then we saw it. "Look, it's water shooting up into the air!" "And it (5) _____ (is come) from the body of a huge sea creature."

We (6) _____ (try) to turn the boat, but the waves pulled us near the creature. For a moment, I thought that this was the end of our journey. The water went up 500 feet high

into the air. An animal that could do this, could kill us easily. Then, we saw that the long black body we thought was an animal, was an island. It was like a small volcano, (7) _____ (shoot) up water, instead of lava. "That's where all this water is coming from." "Axel, check the temperature of the water here." I (8) _____ (take) a thermometer out of my inside jacket pocket and I put it in the water for a few seconds. "163 degrees Fahrenheit."

(ii) Fill in the blanks with appropriate words: [4]

- (a) My grandfather looked _____ me in absence of my parents.
- (b) Rohini is very concerned _____ her father's health.
- (c) Michael has lived in France _____ two years.
- (d) Altaf had many books and papers scattered all _____ the room.
- (e) The phoenix is a legendary bird that rises _____ its ashes.
- (f) The mob rushed onto the pavement, everyone seemed angry _____ everyone else.
- (g) The kids really look _____ to their coach.
- (h) I saw _____ his plan and realized that he was going to cheat us.

(iii) Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using *and*, *but* or *so*. Choose the correct option. [4]

1. It was raining heavily. Mr. Bose was late for the meeting.
 - (a) Although it was raining heavily, Mr. Bose was late for the meeting.
 - (b) As it was raining heavily, Mr. Bose was late for the meeting.
 - (c) Mr. Bose was late for the meeting due to rain.
 - (d) It was raining heavily yet Mr. Bose was late for the meeting.
2. The men went out to see if anyone was missing. The women stayed behind to care for the injured.
 - (a) The men went out to see if anyone was missing while the women stayed behind to care for the injured.
 - (b) The men went out to see whether anyone was missing or not when the women stayed behind to take care of the injured.
 - (c) The women stayed to care for the injured while the men went out to see if anyone was missing.
 - (d) The men went out to see if anyone was missing but the women stayed behind to take care of the injured.
3. She did not know where the key was. I did not know where the key was.
 - (a) She along with I did not know where the key was.
 - (b) Not only I she also did not know where the key was.
 - (c) Neither she nor I know where the key was.
 - (d) Neither did she nor I know where the key was.
4. My mother called me. I rushed out of my room immediately.
 - (a) No sooner did my mother call me than I rushed out of my room.
 - (b) Despite my mother's call, I rushed out of the room immediately.
 - (c) Hardly does my mother call me when I rush out of my room.
 - (d) As soon as my mother called me, I had rushed out of my room.

(iv) Choose the correct option to rewrite the following according to the instructions given after each sentence. [8]

1. You will not get your camera back unless you pay the money. (Begin: Unless...)
 - (a) Unless and until you give the money, you will not get your camera back.
 - (b) Unless you pay the money, you will not give your camera.
 - (c) Unless you pay the money, you will not get your camera back.
 - (d) Unless he pays the money, he will not get the camera back.
2. Raja is a friendly boy who is always helpful. (Begin: Besides...)
 - (a) Besides being friendly, Raja is always helpful.
 - (b) Besides being friendly boy, Raja is always helpful.
 - (c) Besides being a friendly boy, Raja is also helping.
 - (d) Besides being a friendly boy, Raja is always helpful.
3. Everyone will agree that Hari studies hard. (Rewrite using 'deny')
 - (a) All will deny that Hari studies hard.
 - (b) No one will deny that Hari studies hard.
 - (c) Anyone will deny that Hari studies hard.
 - (d) Everyone will deny that Hari studies hard.
4. I made a beautiful card for my mother on her birthday. (Begin: A beautiful card...)
 - (a) A beautiful card was made by me for my mother on my birthday.
 - (b) A beautiful card was made by my mother for me on my birthday.
 - (c) A beautiful card was made by my mother for me on her birthday.
 - (d) A beautiful card was made by me for my mother on her birthday.
5. You will lose marks and you will be scolded as well. (Begin: Not only...)
 - (a) Not only will you be scolded but lose marks too.
 - (b) Not only will you lose marks but also be scolded.
 - (c) Not only will he be scolded but lose marks also.
 - (d) Not only will you be scolded, you will lose mark as well.
6. Mr. Sharma was the Guest of Honour. (End with a question tag)
 - (a) Who was the Guest of Honour?
 - (b) Was Mr. Sharma the Guest of Honour?
 - (c) Mr. Sharma was the Guest of Honour, wasn't he?
 - (d) Mr. Sharma was the Guest of Honour, was he?
7. A fragrant flower is the loveliest creation of nature. (Begin: No other...)
 - (a) No other creation is as lovely as a fragrant flower.
 - (b) No other creation of nature is more lovelier than a fragrant flower.
 - (c) No other creation of nature is as lovely as a fragrant flower.
 - (d) No other creation of nature is lovely such as a fragrant flower.
8. My sister was too short to reach the shelf. (Remove 'too')
 - (a) My sister was too short so that she could not reach the shelf.
 - (b) My sister was so short that she could not reach the shelf.
 - (c) My sister was so small to reach the shelf.
 - (d) My sister was so short that she could not reach the ceiling.